

# Dan Welch

Design Systems Architect

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Hampden, ME | Remote 

## SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 17+ years building design systems and the tooling that drives their adoption. Primary architect of enterprise design systems at Bankrate and Launch That: React/Next.js component platforms, design token pipelines, and internal tools adopted across product and design teams. Strong in TypeScript, React, Node.js, advanced CSS, Storybook, and AI-assisted engineering workflows.

## HIGHLIGHTS

- Led enterprise design systems from ideation through implementation, rollout, and adoption across product teams.
- Partnered with design leadership to define system direction and scalable UI patterns.
- Established automated testing and release workflows, improving developer confidence and adoption.
- Served as Engineering Manager, partnering with stakeholders and PMs to align roadmap priorities with company goals.

## EXPERIENCE

**Bankrate** (a Red Ventures company)

09/2021—06/2026

Senior Software Engineer | Design Systems Architect

Remote

- **Architected and led the implementation of The Ledger**, Bankrate's React/Next.js design system, creating a scalable component platform adopted across product teams. Built 65+ reusable components with TypeScript and Tailwind, supporting white-label theming through a token-based architecture.
- **Built the operational foundation for Ledger**, including automated testing, accessibility validation, CI workflows, token compilation, Storybook documentation, and versioned releases to support reliable adoption across engineering teams.
- **Architected and led the implementation of The Treasury**, Bankrate's first formal design system. Launched Jan 2025 and adopted across a dozen-plus projects with zero production incidents, replacing a legacy CSS framework. Later succeeded by The Ledger following a leadership-directed shift to React/Next.js-native delivery.
- **Led a Storyblok component audit** that eliminated 289 components (~30%), improving maintainability and simplifying content workflows for product teams. Built a custom internal dashboard to track and report progress for stakeholders.
- **Authored Playwright E2E suites** integrated into GitHub Actions. Cut CI execution time by ~76% and caught pre-release regressions before they entered production.
- **Served on Bankrate's A11y and Performance task forces**, resolving WCAG compliance issues and conducting performance audits across product teams, and acting as an internal consultant on Core Web Vitals best practices and front-end performance optimization.
- **Championed AI-assisted development across the team**, integrating Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, and Codex into daily workflows for component generation, documentation, and code review, and sharing practices in bi-weekly team meetings.
- **Drove design system education and adoption company-wide**, facilitating lunch-and-learns for cross-functional groups of engineers, designers, and product managers. One-on-one mentoring with developers on component architecture, advanced CSS, Tailwind optimization, and design system standards.

**Bankrate** (a Red Ventures company)

03/2025 – 09/2025

Engineering Manager | Interim

Remote

- **Managed a team of 7 (4 FTEs + 3 contractors) over 6 months**, driving a ~10% increase in sprint velocity through process improvements and conducting mid-cycle performance reviews.
- **Co-led an internal team hackathon using AI** to accelerate the migration of legacy JavaScript calculators to React and the new design system; the results directly shaped the team's future migration approach.

EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Launch That

Senior Front-End Developer

09/2016—09/2021

Orlando, FL

- **Architected the Ares Framework**, a custom component library and WordPress parent theme powering all Launch That properties, establishing the shared design system foundation that now defines my career. Leveraged it to ship 6 multi-page WordPress sites in a single month.
- **Trained directly with Brad Frost** (creator of the Atomic Design methodology, which focuses on modular interface design) in a hands-on two-day design system workshop, laying the groundwork for the approaches used in Ares and later at Bankrate.
- **Built ReportaRoo and DisavOwl**, two internal productivity tools built in Vue.js that automated marketing reporting and streamlined the SEO link-disavow process, replacing workflows previously done manually by analysts.

Studio Birdsall

Lead Front-End / Senior Web Developer

08/2014—09/2016

Winter Park, FL

- **Led front-end development across 10+ client projects**, including Magento and Shopify e-commerce builds and custom WordPress sites, delivering production-ready websites on schedule.

Full Sail University

Senior Web Developer

10/2008—08/2014

Winter Park, FL

- **Led front-end development for Full Sail University**, including the main marketing sites, blog, hundreds of landing pages & email campaigns, and the interfaces for the university's first online store and online school. Advanced from Web Developer to Senior within three years.

SKILLS

Languages:

TypeScript, JavaScript, Semantic HTML, Modern CSS, PHP

Frameworks & Libraries:

React, Next.js, Vue.js, Astro, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Laravel

Design Systems:

Component Architecture, Storybook, Design Tokens (DTCG), ShadCN Registry, Multi-Brand Theming / White-Labeling, Branding

Practices:

Accessibility (WCAG / A11y), Core Web Vitals, Progressive Enhancement, Responsive Design, Typography, Information Architecture, Figma Collaboration, Design-to-Code Handoff, REST API Integration, UI/UX Consulting, Technical Writing

CMS & Platforms:

Storyblok (Headless CMS), WordPress (Blade or Twig templating, ACF, Gutenberg), Shopify

Testing & CI/CD:

Playwright (E2E), Vitest, Jest, axe-core, Biome, GitHub Actions, Semantic Release (semver / conventional commits)

AI & Modern Workflow:

Cursor, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, OpenAI Codex, MCP tooling; daily use across code generation, refactoring, documentation, rapid prototyping, and design-system development; custom rules & prompt authoring

Leadership:

Engineering Management, Team Mentorship, Stakeholder Alignment, Project Scoping & Roadmapping

EDUCATION

Full Sail University

B.S. Digital Arts & Design

09/2006—08/2008

Winter Park, FL

Valedictorian

University of Maine

Digital Media

09/2005—05/2006

Orono, ME